

GOD THE HOLY SPIRIT

Message by Pastor Dave Labdon

On Sunday we focused on who the Holy Spirit is, how we can know Him in our relationship with God, and the difference this makes in our lives. In this reflection, please allow yourself to know the Holy Spirit more and give Him freedom in your heart and mind to direct, lead and counsel.

GOD THE HOLY SPIRIT

We saw that the Holy Spirit, who is God, is a person and is very active. Consider the below questions and scriptures in these areas:

How do the following Scriptures show that as a person the Holy Spirit has a mind, feelings and will: Roms. 8: 27; Eph. 4: 30; 1 Cor. 12: 11?

Type your response here...

What names and attributes do we see in these passages that show the Holy Spirit as God: Acts 16: 7; 1 Cor. 6: 11; 1 Cor 2: 12; Ps. 139: 7; Job 33: 4?

Type your response here...

What divine actions do you see the Holy Spirit fulfilling: John 16: 8-15; 2 Pet. 1: 21; Gen. 1: 2?

Type your response here...

KNOWING THE HOLY SPIRIT

Jesus taught us that we can know and discern false and true prophets by their fruit (Matt. 7: 15-20). Applying this principle, we can know and recognise the Holy Spirit by His Divine Nature (all of the above & Roms. 1: 20) and His fruit (Gal. 5: 22-23). We can see what the Holy Spirit does, His 'doing,' and therefore know who He is, His 'being.'

Thinking about His Divine nature which we considered above (His name, attributes and actions), how do you see this nature in His fruit (Gal. 5: 22-23)?

Type your response here...

BEING AND DOING

We can also know ourselves by looking at our fruit, what we do shows us who we are, in the same way that what we say reveals what is in our hearts (Luke 6: 45). Amazingly, when we give our lives to God (1 Pet. 1: 3), we can partake of this same divine nature (2 Pet. 1: 3-4) by trusting His promises and thus are empowered by the Holy Spirit within us (John 14: 17, 1 Cor. 6: 19).

What fruit do you see in your life that reflects who you are? What do you see of the fruit of the Spirit (Gal. 5: 22-23) and of the old sinful nature (Gal 5: 19-21)?

Type your response here...

What promises of God may help you in areas of challenge and difficulty?

Type your response here...

In Galatians 5, God teaches us that we need to live by the Spirit (16, 25), be led by Him (18) and keep in step with Him (25). In this way, how can the Holy Spirit help you grow in freedom and new life, pray into your answers?

Type your response here...

STEPPING OUT IN FAITH AND HOPE

In Romans 5: 1-5 we see steps of faith that lead us to peace and joy in the new life we have in God by His grace. No matter what we face, these promises and their reality, are assured and cemented by the presence of the Holy Spirit 'poured' into our hearts. Knowing the Holy Spirit helps confirm and affirm these truths of faith and the Gospel. Meditate on this passage and describe what next steps the Holy Spirit reveals to you.

Type your response here...

"I pray that God, the source of hope, will fill you completely with joy and peace because you trust in him. Then you will overflow with confident hope through the power of the Holy Spirit." Romans 15: 13

Next time we will look at the Baptism and Gifts of the Holy Spirit

Please feel free to speak to Pastors Andaza or Dave on any of these topics